

Cluster 7: Internal Security and Solar Transition

This cluster pairs the declaration of a Naxal-free India with the solar growth backgrounder. It combines internal security and energy transition, both of which are evergreen UPSC themes.

Current Affair: India's Solar Growth Enters a New Era

Date: 2026-08-02 | **Theme:** Solar energy transition | **Subject:** Energy / Environment | **GS Mapping:** GS3 / GS2 | **Priority:** High | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:
PIB backgrounder: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2293256>(=1®=3

Fact snapshot

- FY 2025-26 solar addition: 44.61 GW.
- Non-fossil capacity: 283.46 GW.
- Manufacturing capacity: about 172 GW as of 31 March 2026.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Solar addition	India added 44.61 GW of solar capacity in FY 2025-26.	PIB	■	Prelims + Mains
Non-fossil capacity	Total non-fossil fuel capacity reached 283.46 GW.	PIB	■	Prelims
Manufacturing	Solar module manufacturing capacity reached about 172 GW as of 31 Mar 2026.	PIB	■	Mains

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Backgrounder released on 2 August 2026.	PIB	■
Historical origin	India's solar push has matured through targets, manufacturing and policy support.	Energy policy	■
UPSC relevance	Renewables, industrial policy and climate transition.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
2014	Solar manufacturing base was much smaller	Long-term growth comparison	PIB	■
FY 2025-26	Record solar capacity addition	Current milestone	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Energy	Renewable capacity, manufacturing and grid integration	GS3	Syllabus	■
Environment	Climate commitments and NDC trajectory	GS3	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Panchamrit goals	Climate commitment framework	500 GW non-fossil by 2030	PIB-linked background	■	Mains
PM-SSY	Floating solar add-on	Adjacent solar policy	PIB	■	Mains

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
GW	Gigawatt	Power capacity unit	Energy	PIB	■
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution	Climate commitment under Paris Agreement	Environment	PIB / climate policy	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Capacity	Confusing generation with installed capacity	The release gives installed capacity/addition figures.	PIB	Prelims
Fossil balance	Assuming renewable growth removes the need for grid/storage policy	Storage and grid integration remain important.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Energy transition	How solar growth supports decarbonisation	GS3	Record capacity addition	PIB
Industrial policy	Domestic manufacturing and supply-chain resilience	GS3	Module capacity growth	PIB

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Renewable energy, climate policy, industrial policy	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB solar growth backgrounder	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Environmental Ethics	Sustainability and responsibility to future generations	Solar growth is a cleaner development path when balanced with land, storage and supply-chain needs	Use the release to show practical sustainability	GS3 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Environmental ethics asks us to build prosperity without exhausting the ecological base.
- Solar growth is a policy example of aligning development with lower emissions.
- Use this topic to show that sustainability also needs manufacturing and grid planning.
- Possible answer line: 'A sustainable energy transition is one that is clean, reliable and domestically resilient.'

- Caution: don't treat renewables as automatic; storage and integration matter.

Inference

- The record solar addition number is the headline fact.
- The shift from capacity to manufacturing capability is the deeper story.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: solar is a classic environment-economy topic.
- Static linkage: renewables, manufacturing, climate commitments, grid integration.
- Philosophy linkage: environmental ethics and long-term responsibility.

Revision Notes

- FY 2025-26 solar addition: 44.61 GW.
- Non-fossil capacity: 283.46 GW.
- Manufacturing capacity: about 172 GW as of 31 March 2026.

Current Affair: 4th Tri-Services Future Warfare Course

Date: 2026-08-03 | **Theme:** Future warfare and joint training | **Subject:** Defence / Technology | **GS Mapping:** GS3 | **Priority:** High | **Suggested Depth:** Standard

Sources:
PIB release: [https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2293425\(=1@=3](https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2293425(=1@=3)

Fact snapshot

- Course commenced on 3 August 2026 at Manekshaw Centre.
- Focus: evolving warfare, emerging technologies, MDO.
- Remember this as a training and doctrine topic, not only a weapons topic.

Key Facts Table

Key Fact	Detail	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Date	Course commenced on 3 August 2026.	PIB	■	Prelims
Focus	Evolving warfare, emerging technologies and multi-domain operations.	PIB	■	Mains
Venue	Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi.	PIB	■	Prelims

History / Origin / Background

Background Dimension	UPSC-Safe Detail	Source	Confidence
Immediate trigger	Fourth edition of the course began in New Delhi.	PIB	■
Historical origin	Future warfare courses were created to prepare officers for technology-driven conflict.	Defence training	■
UPSC relevance	Strategic security and future warfare doctrine.	Syllabus	■

Historical Timeline

Year / Period	Timeline Event	Why It Matters	Source	Confidence
Earlier editions	Three editions had already been conducted	Shows continuity	PIB	■
3 Aug 2026	Fourth edition commenced	Current event	PIB	■

Static Theory and Concept Base

Static Area	Theory / Concept	UPSC Static Linkage	Source / Basis	Confidence
Defence	Multi-domain operations and jointness	GS3	Syllabus	■
Technology	Drones, AI, cyber and emerging warfare	GS3	Syllabus	■

Related Policies, Laws, Schemes, Reports and Institutions

Related Item	Type	Connection	Source	Confidence	UPSC Use
Tri-Services course	Training initiative	Jointness and future readiness	PIB	■	Mains
Manekshaw Centre	Venue / institution	Training location	PIB	■	Prelims

Abbreviation and Full Form Table

Abbreviation	Full Form	Context / Meaning	Domain	Source	Confidence
MDO	Multi-Domain Operations	Operations across domains	Defence	PIB	■
CDS	Chief of Defence Staff	Tri-service leadership concept	Defence	PIB	■

UPSC Traps

Trap Area	Possible Trap	Correct Understanding	Source / Basis	Exam Use
Nature	Treating it as a combat exercise	It is a course, not an exercise.	PIB	Prelims
Scope	Thinking only weapon systems matter	Doctrine, technology and integration matter too.	PIB	Mains

Mains Angle

Mains Dimension	Points to Use	GS Paper	Value Addition	Source / Basis
Future readiness	How training adapts to new conflict patterns	GS3	MDO and tech	PIB
Jointness	Why multi-service integration matters	GS3	Operational synergy	PIB

Study Links / Study Map

Study Link Type	What to Study	Why It Matters	Source / Basis	Priority
Static syllabus link	Future warfare, technology, defence doctrine	High	Syllabus	High
Official source link	PIB Tri-Services course release	High	PIB	High

Philosophy Optional Linkage

Philosophy Area	Thinker / School / Concept	Link with Current Affair	How to Use in Philosophy Optional	GS / Essay / Ethics Value	Confidence
Political Philosophy / Ethics	Just war and technological responsibility	Modern war raises questions about proportionality, control and accountability	Use the course as a hook for responsible force design	GS3 / Optional	■

Philosophy Optional Mini-Teaching

- Just war theory is concerned with when force is justified and how it should be constrained.
- Future warfare adds the issue of technological responsibility.
- Use the course as a practical reminder that ethics must evolve with military capability.
- Possible answer line: 'The more powerful the means of war become, the greater the need for disciplined ethical and institutional control.'
- Caution: keep the link illustrative, not overly theoretical.

Inference

- The date and location are straightforward, but the concept is future warfare preparedness.
- Multi-domain operations is the headline doctrinal phrase.

UPSC Synthesis

- Why UPSC cares: defence modernisation is increasingly conceptual, not just equipment-based.
- Static linkage: jointness, MDO, emerging technology, training doctrine.
- Philosophy linkage: just war and technological responsibility.

Revision Notes

- Course commenced on 3 August 2026 at Manekshaw Centre.
- Focus: evolving warfare, emerging technologies, MDO.
- Remember this as a training and doctrine topic, not only a weapons topic.

Cluster Self-Test

- The Naxal-free milestone is tied to which date?

- 31 March 2026
- 15 August 2026
- 1 January 2026
- 2 October 2026

Answer: 31 March 2026

Why: PIB said the milestone was achieved on that date.

- Which figure best captures solar growth in FY 2025-26?

- 44.61 GW solar addition
- 4.61 GW solar addition
- 144.61 MW solar addition
- 7.51% coal growth

Answer: 44.61 GW solar addition

Why: That is the key number.

- What is the key governance idea behind the Naxal-free story?

- Security-development-rehabilitation
- Tax holiday
- Privatisation
- Only policing

Answer: Security-development-rehabilitation

Why: The release stresses the integrated approach.

- Which philosophy lens fits solar expansion best?

- Environmental ethics
- Relativism only
- Hermeneutics only
- None

Answer: Environmental ethics

Why: Energy transition involves sustainability choices.

- The solar release also highlights which structural factor?

- Domestic manufacturing capacity
- Only imports
- Only subsidies
- Only rainfall

Answer: Domestic manufacturing capacity

Why: Module manufacturing growth was highlighted.

Topic Readiness / Worthiness

Topic	Worthiness Score	One-line reason
Naxal-Free India	9.2/10	Internal security success story with doctrine value.
India's Solar Growth	9.0/10	Strong climate + industrial policy topic.